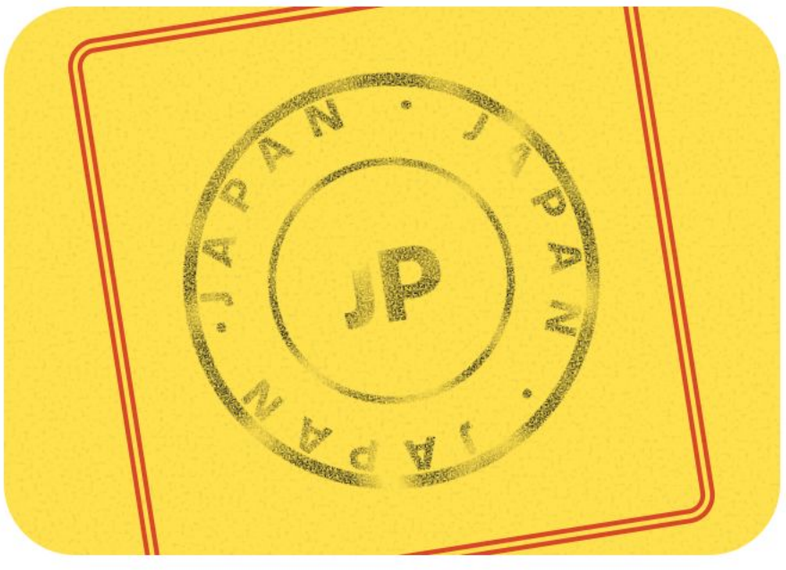
Japanese design trends brands are using now





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Showa 100 made retro mainstream

2025 marked a hundred years since the Showa era began.

The Japan Package Design Association marked it with a Showa 100 packaging show at Shibuya Hikarie.

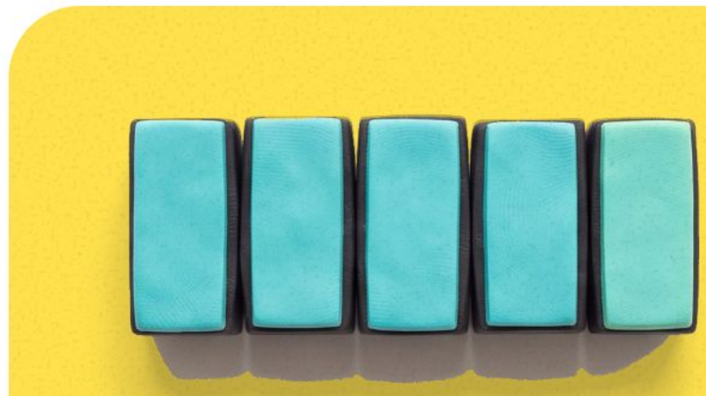
Showa retro	Heisei retro
Signboard type	Digital pop
Warm, analogue	90s and 2000s



Source: 日本パッケージデザイン協会 JPDA

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Familiar beats new



Logotypes

Kept for decades, barely touched

Pack layout

Same structure across redesigns

Revivals

Old snacks back in original packs

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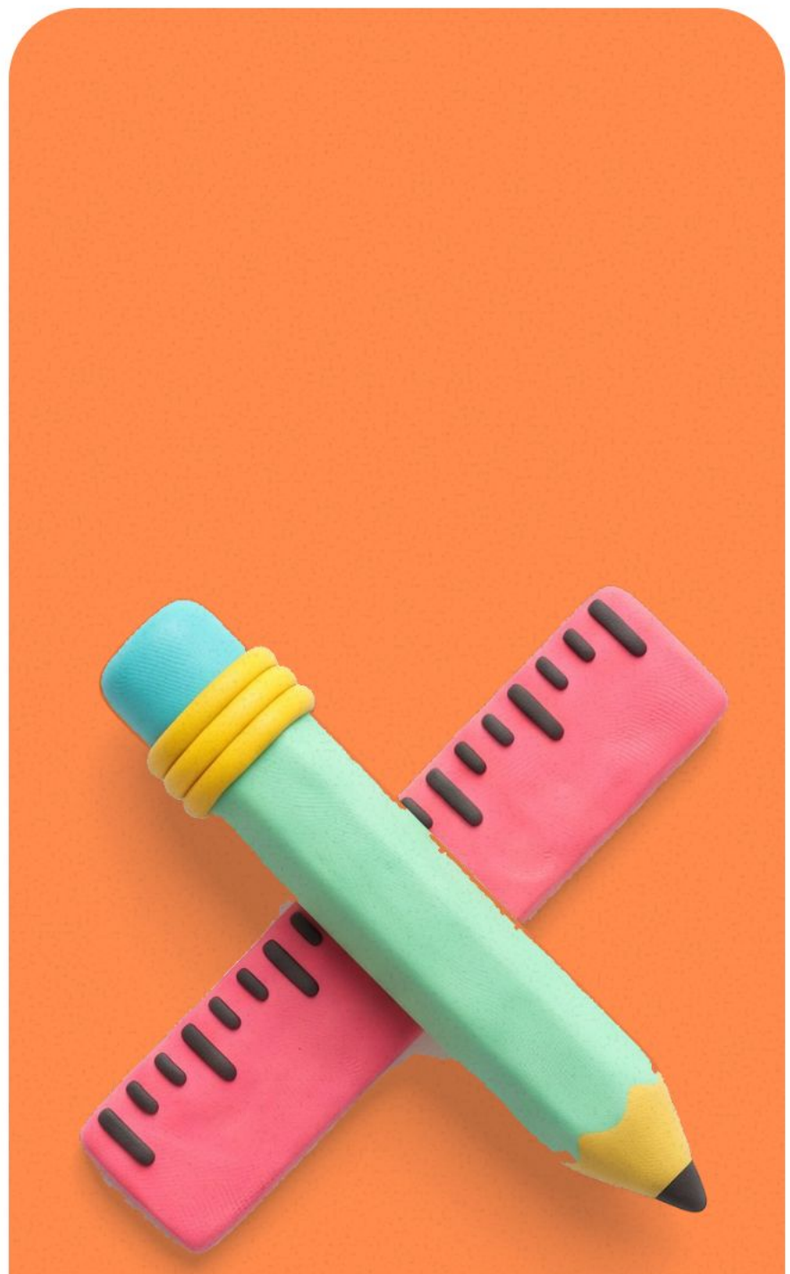
Minimal can backfire

Lawson's 2020 own-brand redesign by nendo drew complaints that products looked alike.

Lawson revised the labels. Clean is fine. Unreadable at a glance isn't.

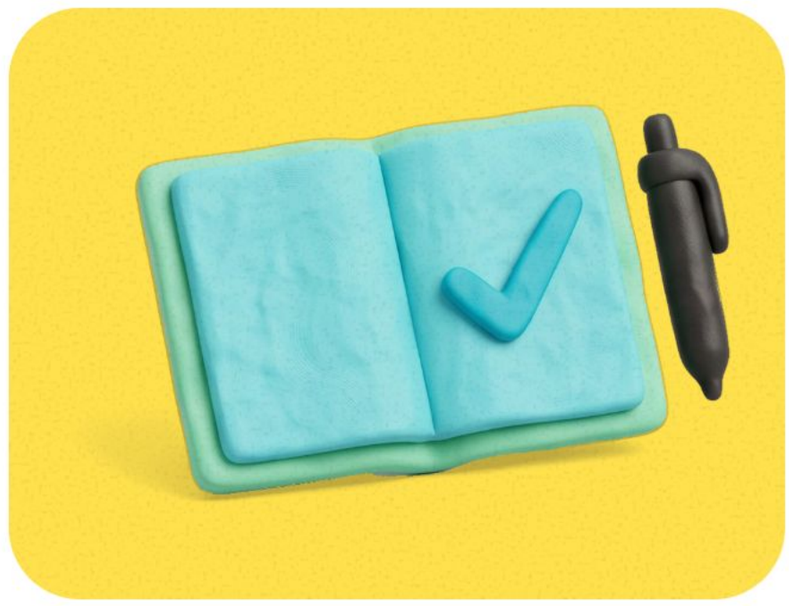
Same pack, tiny product name

Big name, colour by product



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Type is the image



Tategaki

Vertical setting for premium and seasonal

Mixed scripts

Kanji, kana and Latin on one pack

Big type

The headline is the visual

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Where new design shows up first



Channel	What to watch
Konbini own brands	7-Eleven, Lawson, FamilyMart refresh packs often
Seasonal limited	Sakura, summer and autumn runs
Character collabs	Limited packs with popular characters
Station posters	Long, wordy copy read while waiting

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In Japan, new design earns trust by looking familiar.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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